# New Orleans Saints / opponent rulebook

Snapshot October 22, 2026. Games through week 6, last game October 19. Public-data demonstration for weekly preparation.

| Situation / outcome | All matching | Discovery | Check |
|---|---|---|---|
| Third-and-long five-plus rush<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 11/28<br>6 games | 4/15 | 7/13 |
| Third-down blitzers<br>At least one charted blitzer | 28/57<br>6 games | 14/34 | 14/23 |
| Early-down five-plus rush<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 49/165<br>6 games | 33/102 | 16/63 |
| Five-plus rush against motion<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 40/104<br>6 games | 30/84 | 10/20 |
| Five-plus rush against shotgun<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 49/169<br>6 games | 26/96 | 23/73 |
| First-down loaded box<br>Seven-plus box | 77/172<br>6 games | 57/114 | 20/58 |
| Five-plus rush in the red zone<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 17/36<br>6 games | 11/23 | 6/13 |

## Original held-out check: lower Brier is better

Five-plus actual rushers: 87 plays, 2 games. Model 0.2169; base rate 0.2259. Lower Brier on this small check; experimental.
At least one charted blitzer: 87 plays, 2 games. Model 0.2169; base rate 0.2259. Lower Brier on this small check; experimental.
Seven-plus box: 131 plays, 2 games. Model 0.2171; base rate 0.2294. Lower Brier on this small check; experimental.

## Interpretation and limits

Discovery uses weeks 1-4; check uses complete games in weeks 5-6. The policy was fixed before that original check. The next-game estimator now uses all snapshot rows. This is development evidence, with no fresh validation. Rule frequencies do not have independent rule-level predictive validation. Current coverage, safety shell, named rushers, personnel effects, split-formation effects, and concept success are unavailable. Five-plus actual rush is not a quarterback-pressure event. Rehearsal ideas are coaching hypotheses, with no measured concept advantage.

FTN Data via nflverse, with nflfastR/nflverse play-by-play. Adaptations: filtered rows, joins, flags, and summaries. This rulebook and the demo adaptation are CC BY-SA 4.0. Retain attribution and reuse rights. PBP is CC BY 4.0. No BDB or proprietary feed is included.
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